



Figure 3: Test Plan



Figure 4: Assigning a test plan

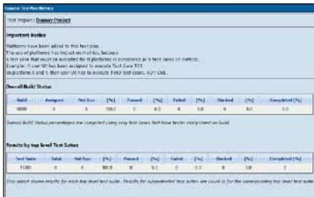


Figure 5: General Test Plan Metrics

Linux, then there is no need for duplication of the test cases. Instead, you can create two platforms and assign the test cases, as per requirements, on the same build.

User management: User management also offers the flexibility to assign and create users as per their roles. The new testers can have the initial level role of ‘tester’, where they can read and execute the test case but cannot actually edit it. The roles can be defined and created as per the actual requirement of the company. Figure 2 gives an overall view from the user management perspective and is taken from the user guide of TestLink.

Creating milestones is another good way of tracking the progress. Once you create a milestone for one project, you can give the percentage completion of milestones for test cases with different priorities. This is based on test case priorities like *High*, *Medium* and *Low*.

Test reports: Once the test plans are executed, the ‘Test reports’ section gives an insight into what is going on over all in the projects. The test reports can be downloaded in various formats and can be sent to various other teams. The report section gives you the exact details about test project completion status, and the answer to some of the common questions applicable to any QA cycle like what percentage of the test cycle is finished, how many test cases are failing or are in the blocked state, test case results as per assigned testers, etc.

Understanding the user interface and the flow takes a little time but once mastered, it really reduces the amount of work that needs to be done.

Working with TestLink

To give a basic idea of the flow, let’s create one project, a few test cases and some testers to actually execute them.

Creating a test project

After logging in to the application, let us create one test project called *Dummy Project*, and make it available as *Active* and *Public* by checking the respective check boxes. You can enable enhanced features also, as per your requirement.

Creating a user

We will also create some dummy users. Click on *Desktop* and select *Dummy Project*. Then click on *Assign User Roles*. Select the *View Users* tab and click on the *Create* button. Create a new user as *user1*.

Fill the user details such as login, first name, last name, password and email id. Do assign a role to the user as *senior tester* from the dropdown menu. Also check the *active* checkbox before saving the form.

Creating a test case

After creating the test project and user, we will create a test case. To create a test case, click on *Test Specification*, select *Dummy Project* and then select *Import*. We will import the test XML files, which you can find with the TestLink installation (browse /opt/lamp/htdocs/testlink/docs/qa_data and select testproject-35-testcases.xml). Select the XML file and upload it. This will create the test cases for the *Dummy Project*.

Creating a test plan

Click on *Desktop* and then click on *Test Plan Management*. Create *Test Plan A* and make it active and public. Once the test plan is created, additional menus like *Test Plan*, *Test Execution* and *Test Plan Contents* will be shown on the home page.

Next, we will create *Build/Release*. Go to *Test Plan*, select *Build/Release* and click on *Create*. Once we have created ‘Builds’, we can see the menu *Test reports* in the home page.

We will now add test cases that are to be executed on two platforms, namely, Windows XP and Linux. To add platforms, click on *Desktop*→*Test Project*→*Platform management* and